

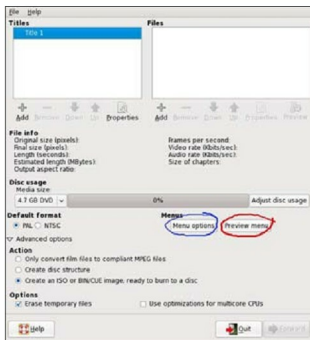


Figure 1: The main DeVeDe window



Figure 2: Title properties

```
pass=2:bitrate=300 -oac mp3lame -lameopts \
cbr:br=224:mode=3 -o output.avi tv://
```

More information on the parameters used here can, of course, be obtained by *man mencoder*, but here is a breakdown of the essentials:

- *-ofavi* specifies the output file format to be an audio-video interleave (a .avi file basically)
- *norm* specifies your camcorder/TV card output standard (mine can be changed)
- *-ovc* defines the type of video encoding to be used (the first uses *lavc* and the second *xvid*)
- *-oac* defines the output audio format (*mp3* in both cases)
- *-o* specifies the output file name

You might need to change some settings depending on your software set-up. For example, you might try *driver=v4l2* if it is supported on your system. Your input device might be different from */dev/video0* (unlikely

though). *input=1* specifies the Composite input on my TV card (that's where I connect the video camera). *mode=3* specifies the same (mono) output to be routed to both the output channels—don't use that if you have a stereo output coming in; use it if you find sound coming out of one speaker only when you play back your output file. *vbitrate* and *bitrate* are the video bitrates and a higher value for either would provide better quality at the cost of a bigger output file. *tv://* is to instruct mencoder to take the input from the TV card.

I suggest you experiment a little with short captures (let's say between 10 and 20 seconds; you need to press *Ctrl+C* to stop the encoding) with different parameters, to see and decide for yourself what works for you before jumping headlong into a big project. You can quickly play back the short clip with *mplayer -outputfilename*.

But as I mentioned, I like working with raw video, so I use:

```
mencoder -of avi -tv driver=v4l:input=1:\
device=/dev/video0:forceaudio:\
norm=PAL:width=640:height=480 \
-ovc copy -oac copy -o output.avi tv://
```

Be warned that this will take up an abnormal amount of disk space because this does a raw dump of both audio and video streams. If disk space is at a premium, it would serve you well to use the *lavc* option (given above) with a higher *vbitrate* so that you have a decent trade-off between hard disk usage and quality.

You'll have to run one of these commands and simultaneously play back the tape on your camcorder. After that you should have your output file on your hard disk. This will be your raw footage. If you are uncomfortable with one large file you can manually pause the camcorder from time to time and start encoding in a different file.

Editing and arranging footage

This really is a part of the DVD creation process that cannot be taught. How you go about this step would depend on your personal aesthetics and sense of artistry. Crisp editing will do wonders for any movie—I guarantee that from personal experience.

What is more pertinent for this article is the software that you could use to do your video magic. There are a number of choices available, but I like *Kino* (that's because it is in many ways similar to *iMovie* on the Mac). Again, Fedora users can just install *Kino* with:

```
yum install kino
```

For my favourite tutorial you can view www.yourmachines.org/tutorials/kino.html. It will teach you everything that you need to know, including how to add titling to your movie (for credits, etc), how to add black video to segregate various portions of your footage, how